

## SECTION TWENTY

# QUICK REFERENCE SHEETS

*These sheets are designed for easy access while writing. Fill them in as you complete other sections, then keep them accessible during drafting.*

## How to Use This Section

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### When to fill this in:

- After completing each section of the workbook, transfer key answers here
- Before starting to draft, review and complete any gaps
- During drafting, update with new details you establish

### How to use while writing:

- Keep these sheets open (printed or in a separate window)
- Check before writing any scene: Are my details consistent?
- Add new details in “Things I’ve Established Mid-Draft” as you create them

**The goal:** Never pause mid-scene wondering “how does this work?” or “did I establish this?” The answers are here.

## WORLD AT-A-GLANCE

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GENRE/SUBGENRE

SETTING IN ONE SENTENCE

YOUR ANSWER

TECH/MAGIC LEVEL

**Continue in Section 9**

*Technology; Section 10 — Magic*

TONE/ATMOSPHERE

**Romance tone:** (intense, tender, angsty, playful, slow-burn)

YOUR ANSWER

☐

Complement

☐

Intentional contrast

### Key Locations (3-5)

**Continue in Section 15**

*Key Locations*

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**Dangerous Regions:**

**Continue in Section 1**

*Geography*

YOUR ANSWER

**Travel Times:**

| FROM | TO | TIME |
|------|----|------|
|      |    |      |
|      |    |      |
|      |    |      |
|      |    |      |
|      |    |      |
|      |    |      |

## Who Rules

### Continue in Section 5

*Government, Power & Law*

GOVERNMENT TYPE

CURRENT RULER(S)

MAJOR FACTIONS/HOUSES

YOUR ANSWER

WHO HAS REAL POWER

# CHARACTER QUICK REFERENCE

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## Protagonist

NAME

**Also called:** (nicknames, titles, aliases) \_\_\_\_\_

AGE

**Physical appearance:** (key details for consistency)

YOUR ANSWER

DISTINGUISHING FEATURES

**What they wear typically:**

**Continue in Section 3**

*Dress, Appearance & Adornment*

YOUR ANSWER

VOICE/SPEECH PATTERNS

KEY PERSONALITY TRAITS

YOUR ANSWER

GREATEST STRENGTH

GREATEST FLAW

WHAT THEY WANT (EXTERNAL GOAL)

WHAT THEY NEED (INTERNAL)

EMOTIONAL WOUND/FEAR

THE LIE THEY BELIEVE

### Love Interest

NAME

**Also called:** (nicknames, titles, aliases) \_\_\_\_\_

AGE

**Physical appearance:** (key details for consistency)

YOUR ANSWER

DISTINGUISHING FEATURES

WHAT THEY WEAR TYPICALLY

VOICE/SPEECH PATTERNS

KEY PERSONALITY TRAITS

YOUR ANSWER

GREATEST STRENGTH

GREATEST FLAW

WHAT THEY WANT (EXTERNAL GOAL)

WHAT THEY NEED (INTERNAL)

EMOTIONAL WOUND/FEAR

THE LIE THEY BELIEVE

## Key Supporting Characters

### Character 1:

NAME

ROLE IN STORY

RELATIONSHIP TO PROTAGONIST

KEY TRAIT

**Character 2:**

NAME

ROLE IN STORY

RELATIONSHIP TO PROTAGONIST

KEY TRAIT

**Character 3:**

NAME

ROLE IN STORY

RELATIONSHIP TO PROTAGONIST

KEY TRAIT

**Antagonist:**

NAME

WHAT THEY WANT

WHY THEY OPPOSE THE PROTAGONISTS

YOUR ANSWER

What system they represent:

**Continue in Section 16**

*Antagonist & Systems*

YOUR ANSWER

# TIMELINE

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## Story Timeline

HOW MUCH TIME PASSES IN THE STORY

STARTING DATE/SEASON

ENDING DATE/SEASON

## Key Dates/Events

Before story begins:

**Continue in Section 7**

*History*

YOUR ANSWER

**Act 1:**

ACT 1:

### *Act 2:*

ACT 2:

### *Act 3:*

ACT 3:

### **Time Between Key Events**

FROM [EVENT] TO [EVENT]

FROM [EVENT] TO [EVENT]

FROM [EVENT] TO [EVENT]

## Important Historical Dates

**Continue in Section 7**

*History & Lore*

YOUR ANSWER

# GLOSSARY

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## Made-Up Terms

TERM

MEANING

TERM

MEANING

TERM

MEANING

TERM

MEANING

TERM

MEANING

**Place Names (with pronunciation if needed)**

YOUR ANSWER

## Character Names (spelling reference)

YOUR ANSWER

## Titles and Forms of Address

### Continue in Section 3

*Language of Deference; Section 8 — Titles & Terms*

YOUR ANSWER

# THE MAGIC SYSTEM

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**Continue in Section 10**

*Magic System*

## Core Rules

WHO CAN USE MAGIC

HOW MAGIC IS ACCESSED

## WHAT MAGIC COSTS

**What magic CANNOT do:**

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## Magic & Romance

**Continue in Section 11**

*Magic & Intimacy*

## HOW MAGIC PUSHES THEM TOGETHER

YOUR ANSWER

HOW MAGIC PULLS THEM APART

YOUR ANSWER

THE INTIMACY MECHANIC

(How does magic create vulnerability or connection?)

YOUR ANSWER

MAGICAL CONSEQUENCE OF THEIR UNION

YOUR ANSWER

### Bond Mechanics (if applicable)

#### Continue in Section 11

*Magic & Intimacy; Section 18 — Agency Check*

**Bond type:** (fated mates, soul bond, telepathic link, magical contract, other)

YOUR ANSWER

☐

Yes

☐

No

☐

One didn't

☐

Yes, freely

☐

At moderate cost

☐

At great cost

☐

No

WHAT THE BOND DOES

YOUR ANSWER

**What the bond doesn't do:** (it doesn't replace genuine emotional connection)

YOUR ANSWER

## Creature Bonds

### Continue in Section 2

*Flora, Fauna & Ecosystems*

BONDED CREATURE/MOUNT (PROTAGONIST)

BONDED CREATURE/MOUNT (LOVE INTEREST)

## HOW CREATURE BONDS AFFECT THE ROMANCE

YOUR ANSWER

# SENSORY PALETTE

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Keep these details consistent throughout your writing.

## Continue in Section 1

*Geography; Section 2 — Flora & Fauna*

### Visual

DOMINANT COLORS OF THE WORLD

**Quality of light:** (golden, grey, harsh, soft, magical glow)

YOUR ANSWER

WHAT THE SKY LOOKS LIKE

VISUAL MOTIFS THAT REPEAT

## Sound

AMBIENT SOUNDS OF PRIMARY SETTING

YOUR ANSWER

SOUNDS ASSOCIATED WITH MAGIC

SOUNDS OF DANGER/TENSION

## Smell

WHAT THE PRIMARY SETTING SMELLS LIKE

YOUR ANSWER

SCENT ASSOCIATED WITH PROTAGONIST

SCENT ASSOCIATED WITH LOVE INTEREST

## Touch/Temperature

CLIMATE FEEL

TEXTURES THAT MATTER

WHAT MAGIC FEELS LIKE

## Taste

Common foods/drinks:

**Continue in Section 2**

*What They Eat*

YOUR ANSWER

LUXURY FOODS

WHAT THEY EAT TOGETHER

# SOCIETY & CULTURE

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**Continue in Section 3**

*Culture, Customs & Daily Life*

## Social Hierarchy

TOP

MIDDLE

BOTTOM

PROTAGONIST'S PLACE

LOVE INTEREST'S PLACE

## Values & Taboos

WHAT THIS CULTURE VALUES MOST

WHAT IS FORBIDDEN/TABOO

THE RULE THEIR ROMANCE BREAKS

## Courtship & Marriage

### Continue in Section 3

*Courtship customs; Section 5 — Marriage laws*

HOW PEOPLE COURT

WHAT TOUCH IS FORBIDDEN/SIGNIFICANT

WHAT MAKES MARRIAGE OFFICIAL

## Language & Communication

### Continue in Section 8

*Language & Communication*

LANGUAGES IN YOUR WORLD

COMMUNICATION BARRIER BETWEEN CHARACTERS

YOUR ANSWER

PRIVATE LANGUAGE OR SIGNALS THEY DEVELOP

YOUR ANSWER

# RELIGION & BELIEF

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## Continue in Section 6

*Religion, Myth & Prophecy*

WHAT PEOPLE BELIEVE

YOUR ANSWER

RELIGIOUS OBSTACLE TO THE ROMANCE

YOUR ANSWER

SACRED VOWS THAT CONFLICT WITH LOVE

YOUR ANSWER

PROPHECY (IF ANY) AND HOW IT AFFECTS THE ROMANCE

YOUR ANSWER

## *Crisis of faith — what makes them question their beliefs?*

CRISIS OF FAITH — WHAT MAKES THEM QUESTION THEIR BELIEFS?

## LAWS THAT MATTER

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**Continue in Section 5**

*Government, Power & Law*

LAW #1

PUNISHMENT FOR BREAKING

EFFECT ON ROMANCE

LAW #2

PUNISHMENT FOR BREAKING

EFFECT ON ROMANCE

LAW #3

PUNISHMENT FOR BREAKING

EFFECT ON ROMANCE

THE LAW THEY WILL BREAK

## THE SPECIFIC CONSEQUENCES

# THE ROMANCE MECHANICS

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## How They're Forced Together

### Continue in Section 13

*Pressure Cooker; Section 14 — Institutions*

#### Primary mechanism:

- ☐ Fated mates/magical bond
- ☐ Arranged marriage/political alliance
- ☐ Academy/institutional partnership
- ☐ Dangerous mission/shared goal
- ☐ Geographical isolation
- ☐ Other: \_\_\_\_\_

#### DETAILS

YOUR ANSWER

☐

Yes

☐

No

☐

At great cost

### The “Why Now?”

**Continue in Section 16**

*The “Why Now?” Test*

***What worldbuilding event kicks off their relationship?***

WHAT WORLDBUILDING EVENT KICKS OFF THEIR RELATIONSHIP?

## *Why couldn't they have gotten together earlier?*

WHY COULDN'T THEY HAVE GOTTEN TOGETHER EARLIER?

THE DEADLINE/TIME PRESSURE

WHAT HAPPENS IF THE DEADLINE PASSES

## **The Invisible Ledger**

**Continue in Section 4**

*Economy, Labour & Resources*

**Who starts with more economic/resource power?** \_\_\_\_\_

**The biggest entry on the ledger:** (the debt, gift, or sacrifice neither can forget)

YOUR ANSWER

**When does the ledger stop mattering?** \_\_\_\_\_

### How They're Kept Apart

**Continue in Section 16**

*Romantasy-Specific Integration*

OBSTACLE 1

WORLDBUILDING SOURCE

OBSTACLE 2

WORLDBUILDING SOURCE

OBSTACLE 3

WORLDBUILDING SOURCE

## Power Dynamics

**Continue in Section 18**

*Agency Check*

WHO STARTS WITH MORE POWER

TYPE OF POWER

WHAT LEVERAGE THE WEAKER CHARACTER HOLDS

## HOW POWER SHIFTS

# PRESSURE POINTS

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## Location-Based

**Continue in Section 15**

*Key Locations*

WHERE THEY'RE TRAPPED TOGETHER

WHERE THEY MUST BE APART

WHERE DISCOVERY IS MOST DANGEROUS

## Time-Based

**Continue in Section 17**

*Dual Clock*

THE DEADLINE

WHAT HAPPENS IF MISSED

**Social-Based**

WHO'S WATCHING

CONSEQUENCES OF BEING CAUGHT

# CONFLICT ENGINES

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## External Conflict

THE MAIN THREAT/PROBLEM

YOUR ANSWER

WHY THEY MUST FACE IT TOGETHER

WHAT HAPPENS IF THEY FAIL

## Internal Conflict

PROTAGONIST'S EMOTIONAL WOUND

HOW IT MAKES THEM RESIST THE RELATIONSHIP

LOVE INTEREST'S EMOTIONAL WOUND

HOW IT MAKES THEM RESIST

### Where They Intersect

*How external conflict forces them to face internal wounds:*

HOW EXTERNAL CONFLICT FORCES THEM TO FACE INTERNAL WOUNDS:

*How resolving relationship helps solve external problem:*

HOW RESOLVING RELATIONSHIP HELPS SOLVE EXTERNAL PROBLEM:

## KEY RULES (The 5-7 That Matter Most)

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**Continue in Section 17**

*Consistency Check*

RULE #1

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE #2

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE #3

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE #4

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE #5

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE #6

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE #7

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

# THE CHOICE MOMENTS

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**Continue in Section 18**

*Agency Check*

***When protagonist actively chooses love interest:***

WHEN PROTAGONIST ACTIVELY CHOOSES LOVE INTEREST:

WHAT IT COSTS THEM

*When love interest actively chooses protagonist:*

WHEN LOVE INTEREST ACTIVELY CHOOSES PROTAGONIST:

WHAT IT COSTS THEM

*The moment they defy worldbuilding rules to be together:*

THE MOMENT THEY DEFY WORLDBUILDING RULES TO BE TOGETHER:

WHAT RULE THEY BREAK

THE CONSEQUENCES THEY ACCEPT

## ROMANTIC TROPES IN USE

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Check all that apply and note specifics:

- ☐ Forced Proximity — How: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Forbidden Love — Why forbidden: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Fated Mates — Type of bond: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Enemies to Lovers — Why enemies: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Power Imbalance — Who has power: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Arranged Marriage — Why arranged: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Only One Bed (or equivalent): \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Touch-Based Magic: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Telepathic/Soul Bond: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Protector Romance — Who protects whom: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Grumpy/Sunshine — Who's which: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Slow Burn — What prevents faster resolution: \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Other: \_\_\_\_\_

*What makes your use of these tropes unique:*

WHAT MAKES YOUR USE OF THESE TROPES UNIQUE:

## THE CLIMAX

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**Continue in Section 16**

*Final Connection Check*

*External climax (fantasy plot resolution):*

EXTERNAL CLIMAX (FANTASY PLOT RESOLUTION):

***Relationship climax (romantic resolution):***

RELATIONSHIP CLIMAX (ROMANTIC RESOLUTION):

***How they happen together:***

HOW THEY HAPPEN TOGETHER:

**What they sacrifice:**

PROTAGONIST

LOVE INTEREST

*Why their union matters to the wider world:*

WHY THEIR UNION MATTERS TO THE WIDER WORLD:

## CONSISTENCY CHECKLIST

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**Continue in Section 17**

*Consistency Check*

### Before Writing a Scene:

- ☐ Travel time consistent with established distances?
- ☐ Magic limitations still apply?
- ☐ Authority figures present or absent for established reason?
- ☐ Established dangers still dangerous?
- ☐ Character knowledge accurate for this point in story?
- ☐ Political/social rules being enforced?
- ☐ Power levels consistent with previous scenes?

### If Breaking a Rule:

- ☐ Is there an in-world explanation?
- ☐ Will there be consequences?
- ☐ Was this possibility set up earlier?

## QUICK FACTS

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CURRENCY

**Timekeeping:** (hours, days, calendar)

YOUR ANSWER

DISTANCE MEASUREMENTS

**Major holidays/festivals:**

**Continue in Section 6**

*Sacred Time*

YOUR ANSWER

COMMON PHRASES/SAYINGS

YOUR ANSWER

IMPORTANT SYMBOLS

WHAT PEOPLE SWEAR BY

TYPICAL FOOD/DRINK

CLIMATE/SEASONS

# THE ELEVATOR PITCH

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THE WORLD

THE CHARACTERS

THE CONFLICT

THE ROMANCE

THE STAKES

***In one sentence:***

IN ONE SENTENCE:

# COMMON READER QUESTIONS

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(Useful for marketing, queries, and pitch materials)

***“What kind of magic system?”***

"WHAT KIND OF MAGIC SYSTEM?"

***“How is it different from [similar book]?”***

"HOW IS IT DIFFERENT FROM [SIMILAR BOOK]?"

**“Is it spicy or fade to black?”** \_\_\_\_\_

**“Major tropes?”** \_\_\_\_\_

☐

Yes

☐

No

☐

Yes

☐

No

☐

HFN (Happy For Now)

**“Standalone or series?”** \_\_\_\_\_

## THINGS I’VE ESTABLISHED MID-DRAFT

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(Add details here as you write so you don’t forget them. Include page/chapter where established.)

YOUR ANSWER

## NOTES TO SELF

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(Reminders, inconsistencies caught, things to fix in revision)

YOUR ANSWER

## THE INTEGRATION MANTRA

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**Continue in Section 16**

*Web of Systems*

**Every worldbuilding element should do at least two of these:**

1. Push characters together OR pull them apart (ideally both)
2. Create opportunities for intimacy OR obstacles to overcome
3. Force meaningful choices with real costs
4. Have consistent rules the romance works within
5. Matter to both the fantasy plot AND the relationship

**If an element doesn't do at least two of these, cut it or strengthen it.**

## FINAL CHECKLIST BEFORE DRAFTING

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- ☐ World at-a-glance complete
- ☐ Character details consistent
- ☐ Timeline established
- ☐ Magic rules clear (including what magic can't do)
- ☐ Bond mechanics defined, if applicable (consent, rejection, limits)
- ☐ Key locations defined
- ☐ Religion/belief system sketched (if relevant to romance)
- ☐ "Why now?" catalyst identified
- ☐ Obstacles identified with worldbuilding sources
- ☐ Power dynamics mapped
- ☐ Economic ledger understood
- ☐ Choice moments identified
- ☐ Climax integrates romance and fantasy
- ☐ Consistency rules clear
- ☐ Integration Score completed (Section 16)

**Ready to write.**



Keep these sheets accessible. Update as your story evolves.

Happy writing!